

The accord is the single-most important act between the two countries in 60 years

NUCLEAR ASSETS

- 15 power reactors generating 3,700 MW of electricity, 8 more under construction and 3 are planned.
- 3 research reactors to meet fissile material requirements for India's nuclear weapons programme.
- 1 operating fast breeder reactor and another under construction.
- 1 operating uranium enrichment plant.
- 3 spent fuel reprocessing units.
- 6 heavy-water production plants.

UNDER THE ACCORD, INDIA HAS AGREED TO PUT 14 OF ITS 22 POWER REACTORS UNDER SAFEGUARDS IN A PHASED MANNER BY 2014

THE CONTENTIOUS ISSUES



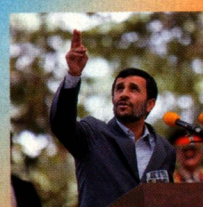
PRAMOD PUSHKARNA

RIGHT TO TEST: Critics say the deal inhibits India's ability to conduct nuclear tests. The Government maintains that India retains its sovereign right to do so and has immunised its reactors from the consequences.



BHASKAR PAUL

REPROCESSING: To avoid a Tarapur-like crisis, India has been granted upfront rights to reprocess spent fuel in a specially-created national facility. BJP says the agreement is vague on it and the exercise would prove costly.

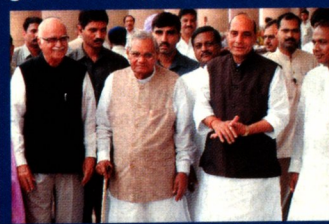


AP PHOTO SAURABH DAS

FOREIGN POLICY: The Left parties say that the deal forces India to toe the US line on foreign policy and points to pressure on Iran. The Government says it's foolish to think that India can be made a vassal state to anyone.

JULY 27, 2007

Details of the 123 Bilateral Agreement on Peaceful Nuclear Co-operation between India and the US are made public after both governments approve it. Indian and



AP PHOTO SANTOSH KUMAR

US negotiators spend one whole week in Washington DC ironing out the differences and reaching a consensus. But both BJP and Left reject the agreement for different reasons. BJP says under the Hyde Act, India would lose its option of conducting a nuclear weapons test.

JUNE 9, 2007

Negotiations between India and the US over the so-called bilateral 123 Agreement for peaceful nuclear co-operation are grounded over certain provisions of the Hyde Act. Manmohan speaks to Bush on the sidelines of the G-8 summit in Germany to sort out the remaining issues.



PTI PHOTO

DECEMBER 16, 2006

US President signs the Henry J. Hyde US-India Peaceful Atomic Energy Cooperation Act. Earlier, the US Congress votes with overwhelming majorities the bill enabling the Act. There are sections in it that trouble India and Bush says he will use his executive powers to change these.



AP PHOTO PABLO MARTINEZ MONSIVIS

clear test in 1974, Washington had imposed stiff sanctions against India. It reneged on its agreement to supply fuel for the Tarapur reactors that it had helped India set up earlier and also refused consent to reprocess the spent fuel. The US then built a worldwide technological denial regime to prevent India from doing trade even in the civilian nuclear power sector unless it joined the Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT) and gave up its nuclear weapons.

India's nuclear ambitions became a bone of contention for successive US governments and relations deteriorated further when India conducted five more tests in 1998.

The solution that Bush and Manmohan would arrive at would ironically stem from a proposal made by the NDA government which had initiated a dialogue with the US called the Next Step in the Strategic Partnership (NSSP). Brajesh Mishra, the then national secu-

rity adviser, had proposed to secretary of state Colin Powell that India was willing to put some of its nuclear reactors under safeguards in return for lifting the ban on fuel supply to them. Mishra says he proposed putting only two reactors but got no response from Powell and didn't push it further. A senior official says: "Even if Mishra is right, if we were going to invest so much political capital to do it, why play for peanuts?"

So Manmohan's negotiators came

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